

NICHOLLS STATE UNIVERSITY

Request for HSIRB Exemption

1. Name(s) of Principal Investigator(s): Dr. Christopher Castille Phone: 985-449-7015
Other Investigators: None
Faculty Sponsor (If Student Research): N/A (faculty PI) Phone: N/A
2. College: Al Danos College of Business Administration Department: Management and Marketing Phone: 985-449-7015
3. Title of Project or Proposal: HR Situational Judgment Test: Evidence-Based HR Decision-Making
4. **Description of Project or Proposal (attach additional information as needed):**
 - a. Briefly describe the population of human subjects involved (e.g., University students, community members, athletes, homemakers, school children, etc.) **You MUST indicate if this participation is VOLUNTARY or NOT. Subjects must be 18 or older for HSIRB Exemption.**
Two groups, all age 18+: (1) Nicholls undergrads (MNGT 425 / related M&M) — research use of course ratings is VOLUNTARY (grade shield). (2) HR/working professionals — VOLUNTARY. Full detail: Attachment A.
 - b. Briefly describe your research procedures and techniques of data collection (e.g., interview, questionnaire, test administration, observation of public behavior, etc.). **You MUST include a printed copy of any data collection instrument(s) as well as active link(s) if online or electronic data collection methods are being utilized.**
Electronic consent; online HR SJT (27 scenarios; optional 1–5 ratings; Skip allowed); feedback PDF. Instrument + active links in Attachment A (also <https://bayoupal.nicholls.edu/hsirb/studies/hr-sjt/run/>).
 - c. Briefly describe the objectives of your research (e.g., what hypotheses you are testing.)
Compare student vs. HR-professional tactic-effectiveness ratings; identify educational gaps; examine training effects toward professional norms. See Attachment A.
5.
 - a. How will you recruit subjects? **YOU MUST submit VERBATIM COPIES** of all letters, emails, notices, advertisements, etc. and/or all oral presentations to be used to recruit subjects/ participation in the research project (e.g. scripts of direct person-to-person solicitation, telephone solicitation, newspaper solicitation, letters of solicitation, email solicitation, notices of solicitation posted to Facebook or Moodle, etc.).
Students: course/PRAMS announcement + secondary-data consent. Professionals: network outreach. VERBATIM recruitment script: Attachment A, Section 5a.
 - b. List all criteria for including subjects.
Inclusion: age 18+; students in MNGT 425/related M&M at Nicholls; professionals with current/recent HR experience; internet access.

Exclusion: under 18; cannot complete online assessment; prior participation; students not at Nicholls; no HR experience (pro arm). See Attachment A.
 - c. List all criteria for excluding subjects.

6. Describe subject benefits and costs:

- a. Indicate what, if any, benefits may accrue to each of the following: (Payment to research subjects for participation in studies is considered a benefit.)

1) The human subjects involved:

Feedback report; learning about evidence-based HR/SJT; contribution to research; optional aggregated infographic (no individuals identified). No monetary payment.

2) Individuals who are not subjects, but who may have similar problems:

Educators and HR trainers may use findings to improve HR education and assessment.

3) Society in general:

Advances understanding of HR situational judgment and evidence-based HR education.

- b. State type, amount, method of disbursement, schedule of payment to be offered, and the effect of withdrawal from participation in the study, if any:

None. No monetary compensation. Withdrawal has no payment effect. Research consent is voluntary with no grade impact for students. Feedback/infographic only.

- c. Estimated costs to each subject due only to the research participation:

1) Time (i.e., total time commitment for the duration of the project)

Live assessment: ~45–60 minutes. Class secondary-data consent: time to read/sign only (no new tasks).

2) Money

None.

3) Is repeated testing required? Explain:

No. Optional pre/post training comparison only if used later under the same protocol.

7. BASIS OF REQUEST FOR EXEMPTION - One of the following (A-E) must be checked.

- _____ A. The research will be conducted only in established or commonly accepted educational settings (like classrooms) **AND** it involves normal educational practices such as research on regular and special educational instructional strategies, or research on the effectiveness of, or the comparison among, instructional techniques, curricula or classroom management methods.
- _____ B. It will be conducted using only questionnaire or interview survey methods **AND** the subjects are elected or appointed public officials or candidates for public office.
- _____ C. It is limited to the collection and study of existing data, documents, records, pathological or diagnostic specimens which are available to the public.

(Request options for exemption continued on next page)

- ☒ D. It is limited to the collection and study of data obtained using only the following techniques **AND** the data or information obtained will be recorded in such a manner that subjects cannot be *identified, directly or indirectly*, through identifiers linked with the subjects:

Check the applicable technique(s):

- ☒ ☐ 1. The data will be obtained through the use of educational tests (cognitive, diagnostic, aptitude, achievement, etc.), or
- ☐ 2. Data will be obtained by observing the public behavior of subjects, or
- ☒ ☐ 3. Data will be obtained using survey or interview procedures, or
- ☒ ☐ 4. Data will be obtained from existing documents, records, pathological or diagnostic specimens.

- ☐ E. It is limited to the collection and study of data obtained by:

1. Observing the public behavior of the participants, or
2. Using survey or interview procedures, **AND:**

BOTH OF THE FOLLOWING MUST BE CHECKED IF E-2 IS THE BASIS FOR THE REQUESTED EXEMPTION:

- ☐ i) The information collected about the subjects behavior ***does not involve*** sensitive subjects such as illegal or immoral conduct, drug or alcohol use, sexual behavior, mental illness, or other possibly personally embarrassing subjects **AND**,
- ☐ ii) The information collected about subjects, if it became known to outsiders, could not reasonably be expected to place the subject at risk of civil or criminal liability, or be damaging to the subjects social or financial standing or employability.

8. **Attach copies of current CITI Training certificate(s) for all investigators. Faculty Sponsors of student research must provide a copy of their current CITI Training certificate. Please be sure to select (enroll) and complete the appropriate series of modules based on your area / learner group. URL TO CITI TRAINING: <https://about.citiprogram.org/en/homepage/> There are 5 different learner groups for Nicholls State University:**

Faculty Researchers / Faculty Sponsors – If you are conducting research involving human subjects or if you are the faculty sponsor / supervisor of student research which does NOT involve the areas of biomedical research. **NOTE: Nursing and Allied Health Faculty are required to complete the HIPAA module (not suggested as for all other faculty).**

Student Researchers (Not Nursing/Allied Health): Any research being conducted by a student or student group (either thesis, class project, service/experiential learning, or academic oriented research) where human subjects are involved (surveyed, experimental design, and/or observation).

IRB Members: Any member of the HSIRB Committee at Nicholls State University

CITI certificate attached for PI Dr. Christopher Castille (Social/Behavioral; completed 10-May-2024; expires 10-May-2026; Record ID 59381539). See Attachment A.

Nursing and Allied Health Students: Modules in this group include the Basic Social-Behavioral-Educational Modules as well as additional required modules, as required by consensus of the Faculty within the respective College and Department.

Biomedical Data or Specimens/Researchers (Faculty and Students): Any Faculty / Students whose Research involves the use or collection of biomedical data and/or specimens.

NOTE: Depending on the exact protocols used. If additional data is collected by means of a survey from subjects, then the researchers (both faculty, faculty sponsors and students) are required to complete additional modules (Faculty – Faculty Researchers/Research Sponsors; Students – Student Researchers (Not Nursing or Allied Health)).

9. STATEMENT OF RISK:

The undersigned certify that they believe that the conduct of the above described research creates no risk of physical or emotional harm, or social or legal embarrassment to any participating human subject.

Dr. Christopher Castille (PI) — signature/date on line below

Signature of Principal Investigator Date

10. FACULTY SPONSOR (if a student is the principal investigator)

N/A — Principal Investigator is faculty

Signature of Faculty Sponsor Date

11. RECOMMENDATION OF HSIRB REPRESENTATIVE OR HSIRB CHAIR:

I recommend that the above described research project be exempt from review.

Signature of Chairperson Date

HSIRB PROTOCOL NUMBER _____
(Assigned by HSIRB)

NOTE – APPROVE HSIRB Research is valid for a 12 month period of time from the date approved. Approved research can be renewed and extended for a 1 year period at the request of the principle investigator / faculty member – PRIOR to the expiration of an existing HSIRB Protocol Number. Projects can be renewed a maximum of two (2) times. Any faculty wishing to continue a research project beyond year 3 **must** submit a new request. If approved, a new HSIRB Protocol Number will be issued.

The mailing or distribution of surveys or the collection of data may begin ONLY after this form has received committee approval (ALLOW 10 DAYS FOR PROCESSING) and has been properly filed with the HSIRB Representative or HSIRB Chairperson. It must have signatures of the Principal Investigator(s) or Faculty Sponsor. The Committee may, upon review of this application, deny the request for an exemption. To inquire about approval status, please contact the HSIRB Representative you submitted the application to or the HSIRB Chairperson.

NICHOLLS STATE UNIVERSITY

Request for HSIRB Exemption — Attachment A

HR Situational Judgment Test: Evidence-Based HR Decision-Making

PI: Dr. Christopher Castille | Continuation for form rev9_2019.v2

4a. Population

Two groups, age 18+: (1) Nicholls undergrads in MNGT 425 / related M&M — research use of course ratings is VOLUNTARY (grade shield). (2) HR/working professionals — VOLUNTARY.

4b. Procedures / links

Electronic consent; optional demographics (professionals); online HR SJT (27 scenarios; optional 1–5 ratings; Skip allowed); feedback PDF. Instrument review: <https://bayoupal.nicholls.edu/hsirb/studies/hr-sjt/run/> | Professional consent: <https://bayoupal.nicholls.edu/hsirb/studies/hr-sjt/professional-consent/> | Class consent: <https://bayoupal.nicholls.edu/hsirb/studies/hr-sjt/student-data-consent/>

4c. Objectives

Compare student vs professional tactic ratings; identify educational gaps; examine whether training shifts student ratings toward professional norms.

5a. VERBATIM recruitment script

Study Title: HR Situational Judgment Test: Evidence-Based HR Decision-Making. Description: You will complete an online HR Situational Judgment Test with 27 HR management scenarios. For each scenario, you will rate the effectiveness of different HR tactics. You will receive a feedback report. Your responses will be used for research on HR education and decision-making. Duration: Approximately 45–60 minutes. Mode: Online. Requirements: Must be 18 years of age or older.

5b/5c. Inclusion / Exclusion

Inclusion: 18+; students in MNGT 425/related courses at Nicholls; professionals with current/recent HR experience; internet access. Exclusion: under 18; cannot complete online assessment; prior participation; students not at Nicholls; no HR experience (professional arm).

7. Exemption basis

Category D checked. Techniques checked: D-1 educational tests (SJT), D-3 survey/interview procedures (online ratings), and D-4 existing documents/records (student secondary-data arm). Data recorded with anonymized codes; names not stored with research data.

8. CITI

Dr. Christopher Castille — Human Subjects Research (Social/Behavioral); completed 10-May-2024; expires 10-May-2026; Record ID 59381539. Attach [citiCompletionCertificate_4689946_59381539.pdf](#).